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REVENUE SHARING FUNDS THREATENED U.S. GOVERNMENT CONFIRMS OAKLAND RACISM CHARGES



A broad spectrum of community leaders attended a press conference last week to reveal information received from the federal government exposing the racist hiring practices of the Oakland city government. Those attending the conference were (from left to right) MICHAEL WHITE, ALPHONSO GALLOWAY, Pastor J. ALFRED SMITH, SANDRE SWANSON, and RAY CLARK.

(Oakland, Calif.) — In response to administrative complaints by this city's Black policemen and firemen, the federal government has confirmed widescale discrimination against Blacks, women and other minorities in the police, fire and public works departments and ordered "corrective action" within 60 days or the possibility of loss of federal funds.

This development came to light last week when Black community leaders, led by Pastor J. Alfred Smith of Allen Temple Baptist Church of East Oakland, revealed to a hastily called press conference the existence of a letter received by Oakland Mayor John H. Reading from Graham W. Watt, director of the Office of Revenue Sharing in the U.S. Treasury Department.

The letter, dated July 31, 1975, reveals that the findings of a civil rights investigation of Oakland, conducted on October 30-31, 1974, in response to complaints showed that Oakland is clearly in violation of sections of the Civil Rights Act as regards hiring, promotion, training and firing of Blacks, other minorities and women, in the respective departments.

Present with Pastor Smith at the press conference, held at his church last Thursday afternoon, were Raymond Clark, president of the Oakland Black Officers Association, Michael White, vice-president of the Black Firefighters Association, Alphonso Galloway, executive director of the Oakland NAACP, and Sandre Swanson, administrative aide to Congressman Ronald V. Dellums.

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